

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in commercial contracts, legal research and document review at BCLP, Adobe and Q-Legal, alongside client-facing casework at Citizens Advice. Experienced in reviewing and amending commercial agreements, identifying contractual and compliance risks, preparing legal documents, managing case files across competing deadlines and communicating clearly with clients and stakeholder teams. Comfortable working independently on discrete matters under solicitor supervision, with a particular interest in commercial disputes and regulatory issues.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**
Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation on data protection and GDPR development across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**
University College London

- Modules included Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**
King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; included partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**
Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial in a complex investment arbitration
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended sections of the memorial; conducted legal research in support of the team
- Became the sole junior supporting the team in the lead-up to a significant submission deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time delivery
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**
Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Reviewed documents and prepared electronic hearing bundles; assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials for hearing preparation
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines
- Maintained matter records via iManage; assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements and deadline tracking

Adobe · London **June 2022 – Aug 2022**

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with Adobe's internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Supported acceptance of standard contractual terms: flagged provisions needing legal input and communicated amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

Q-Legal · Remote

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech
- Identified legal and compliance risks from the client's data processing and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet a fixed deadline

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Interviews clients across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options, translating complex rules into clear, practical guidance

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; contract review and drafting; documentary analysis; concise report writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters